millennium BCE, coral has been found at the neolithic-chalcolithic sites of Navdatoli in Central India, Prakash in Maharashtra, and Maski in Karnataka. In early historic India, much before *c*. 200 BCE, coral beads are found at Taxila, Rajghat, Ganwaria-Piprahwa, and Vaishali. They are also found in Nevasa and Paunar in Maharashtra, and at T. Kallupati in Tamil Nadu. This long history of usage may be one reason why it was considered sacred by Buddhists and Hindus. The references to coral form part of the data that I had compiled for my PhD thesis in the early 1990s; there is no clarity on whether these were from the Mediterranean or Indian seas. In fact, the early presence of coral from Taxila to Tamil Nadu is evidence of the possibility of the *Arthashastra's* core being Mauryan, and not later, as argued by Olivelle. See Olivelle 2013: 26–7 for the argument relating to coral. For references to coral in pre-Mauryan and Mauryan times, Lahiri (1992).

45. *AS* 2.4.6. Kangle (1972): pt II, 68.

46. *AS* 1.20.2. Kangle (1972): pt II, 48.

47. *AS* 1.20.6–8. Kangle (1972): pt II, 49.

48. For a discussion of this, Guruge (1993): 29–31.

49. *AS* 1.19.6–24. Kangle (1972): pt II, 46.

50. Tyldesley (2008): 33.

51. A prince's training has been described in the *AS* (all citations in the following footnotes pertaining to it are from Kangle (1972), pt II, *AS* 1.5.7–12). For the age of tonsure (called 'Chaula karma' in *AS* 1.5.6) and initiation (or Upanayana in *AS* 1.5.7), *Asvalayana-grhya Sutra* says that the first should be performed in the third year after birth or according to family usage, and the second according to caste, i.e. for a brahmana, kshatriya, or vaisya boy the proper ages are 8th, 11th, and 12th from conception. See Kane (1994): vol. V, pt I, 606–7.

52. *AS* 1.5.14 states that the 'Puranas, Itivrtta, Akhyayika, Udaharana, Dharmshastra and Arthshastra—these constitute Itihasa.' See Kangle (1972): pt II, 11. Puranas deal with the creation and destruction of the universe, king lists, heroes, sages, geography, and philosophy. Arthashastra is as a discipline the ancient equivalent of modern economics.

53. *AS* 1.20.12. Kangle (1972): pt II, 50. The term used is 'kumaraa-dhyaksa sthanam'.

54. *AS* 1.17.23 says that 'like a piece of wood eaten by worms, the royal family, with its princes undisciplined, would break the moment it is attacked.' See Kangle (1972): pt II, 41.

55. See *AS* 1.17. Kangle (1972): pt II, 39–43. The section's heading is 'Guarding against Princes'.